15.6=78%

The assessment covered the LO1 and LO2.

The discussion about evolution is fine. You have given a good narrative. The first era is discussed comprehensively fulfilling all the criteria. The other phases need a bit more improvement including the roles and specifying the time frame. Use this feedback for assessment 2.

I agree with your discussion about the frameworks such as TOGAF and SAFe, justification about its suitability etc. but you need to provide some business-related citations or good discussions around business as we are focusing more on the business when writing this assessment

Criteria	10-9	8-7	6-5	4-0
Evolution of Practices and Roles Analysis (LO1)	The analysis demonstrates a profound and insightful exploration of the historical evolution of practices and roles in business solutions architecture. It covers key changes and advancements, showcasing a comprehensive understanding. Implications within the organizational context are thoroughly discussed.	7.8 The d det evo lt cap imp understanding.	The analysis offers a basic exploration of the evolution of practices and roles, touching on some key changes, though with limited depth.	The analysis lacks meaningful exploration of the evolution of practices and roles, presenting a superficial examination without depth or detail.

Framework Suitability Evaluation (LO2)	The evaluation demonstrates an exemplary understanding of the framework's suitability, with a detailed assessment of strengths and weaknesses. The analysis demonstrates a thorough understanding of alignment with the practical business needs of the chosen organisation through specific examples or cases.within the context of the chosen New Zealand-based organization.	The evaluation presents a clear and de[illegible] e frame[illegible] g streng[illegible] e alignm[illegible] ess needs[illegible] releva[illegible] within the context of the chosen New Zealand-based organization 7.8	The evaluation offers a basic assessment of the framework's suitability, touching on strengths and weaknesses with some depth. The alignment with practical business needs is outlined but lacks thorough illustration with examples or cases, within the context of the chosen New Zealand-based organization	The evaluation lacks a meaningful assessment of the framework's suitability, presenting a superficial analysis without depth or detail. Alignment with practical business needs is unclear, and specific examples or cases are lacking, within the context of the chosen New Zealand-based organization

1. Introduction

Business Solutions Architecture is prevalent among business in the contemporary period. But what is Business Solutions Architecture? It is the analysis of current business processes, goals, and objectives defines significant pain points and required resources, technologies, and systems. It's main objective is to ensure that the proposed solution meets business needs and deliver expected results (Paratela, 2023). According to Patti, (2020), a successful business solution architecture brings together technical solution plans with the business processes running across the systems and overlays team operating models on top of both.

Enterprise Architecture on the other hand, is the practice of analysing, designing, planning, and implementing enterprise analysis to successfully execute on business strategies (White, 2022). Enterprise Architecture helps businesses going through digital transformation, since Enterprise Architecture focuses on bringing both legacy applications and processes together to form seamless environment (Gillis, 2023).

Xero, an accounting software company located in New Zealand. Xero provides accounting software to small business owners (*About Xero | Xero NZ*, 2024). Like other companies, Xero would benefit from Business Solutions Architecture to identify business needs and deliver results. Xero would also need Enterprise Architecture for digital transformation.

This report will critically analyse how the proposed framework will affect the organization Xero. Part two will discuss the evolution and key changes to the software industry. Part three will discuss how Agile framework is suitable for Xero and what are the strengths and weaknesses of Agile framework. The report will conclude at part four which discusses the summary and conclusion.

Commented [NJ1]: Intro is fine

2. Evolution

Back when Xero was founded in 2006, one of their business goals is to provide accounting services to small businesses (*About Xero | Xero NZ*, 2024). During this time, the Internet blurred the traditional boundaries between software products and services. Software firms are generating revenue by deploying software over the Internet as a service (Campbell-Kelly & Garcia-Swartz, 2007). It is likely that Xero capitalized on providing accounting services to small businesses through the Internet as a service. The Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) business model is also starting to mature rapidly, shifting from one-time software product sales to a subscription-based, ongoing relationship between vendor and customer, one example includes Salesforce.com for customer relationship management (CRM) and Oracle on Demand (Campbell-Kelly & Garcia-Swartz, 2007). Xero can maximize this by leveraging Salesforce servers to use with other Salesforce services. For the methodologies, the Agile methods era began around 2000, emphasizing rapid application development and concurrent engineering, design, and code. Agile methods focused on the team, work, and people, introducing practices like self-organizing teams and daily standups (Gruhn & Striemer, 2018). It is like that Xero also used similar Agile method to incrementally improve their accounting software. Being an organization that uses Agile methodologies, their team would be composed of developers, product owner, scrum master, architects (Staron, 2021). Developers are responsible for building software efficiently and effectively to specifications (Boehm, 2006). Product owner is responsible for prioritizing requirements and optimizing feature deliveries at the team level. Scrum master is responsible for facilitating the team's adherence to Scrum practices (Masuda & Viswanathan, 2019). Architects which include an architecture owner where the role is to involve the entire team in making informed architectural decisions, guiding design with patterns, and prioritizing architectural features and risks (Gruhn & Striemer, 2018), and an enterprise architects which collaborate with agile teams, acting as primary stakeholders and specialists, particularly in aligning with IT strategies, defining non-functional requirements, and during architectural envisioning and modelling phases (Masuda & Viswanathan, 2019).

In 2008, cloud computing began to emerge, with initial efforts focused on migrating existing IT systems and traditional tiered applications to virtualized cloud environments without significant redesign. The emergence of cloud computing was correlated with a steady decline in Service-Oriented Architecture (SOA), as cloud computing becomes more viable (Kratzke, 2018). Benefits of cloud migration includes scalability, cost efficiency, business continuity, security, agility & innovation, and collaboration & remote work, however, the challenges are costly migration, and skill gaps (Armstrong, 2024). During this time, Xero could have also migrated their traditional IT system to a cloud service provider. This will benefit Xero as they could scale up servers when they have new clients, have redundancy in case of server outages, increased security, have access to new and upcoming technologies like AI, machine learning, big data analytics, employees and clients can collaborate remotely. However, cloud migration can be expensive as well as hiring IT employees with experience on the cloud (Armstrong, 2024).

Commented [NJ2]: What is the role?

Within the last ten years, there are several new technologies and frameworks that are rapidly emerging in the IT industry, one is the implementation of serverless, starting with AWS Lambda, marking a new architectural shift towards more decentralized and distributed services (Gruhn & Striemer, 2018). For Xero, implementing serverless means they don't need IT engineers to maintain physical servers, and can focus entirely on software development. Another new concept is the implementation of microservices. Second is the application of DevOps, it represents a significant evolution in software development, aiming to unify and optimize the entire software development lifecycle (Gruhn & Striemer, 2018). For Xero,

Commented [NJ3]: Starting from when? 2008 or 2015? Need to be clear adopting DevOps has several advantages in today's age. First is enhanced speed and responsiveness as DevOps allows companies to deliver software quickly and efficiently, adapting rapidly to market changes (Gruhn & Striemer, 2018). Second is improved software quality and reliability by integrating development and operations and automating quality assurance, DevOps helps companies to release software more reliably and ensures high quality (Gruhn & Striemer, 2018). Third is competitive advantage by having the ability to develop and deploy applications rapidly, reliably, and with continuous innovation can provide a significant competitive advantage for internet-facing organizations (Richards, 2015). Fourth is cost optimization by early identification and resolution of non-functional issues, such as those found during load testing, can lead to reduced time and cost for fixes (Kratzke, 2018) Fifth is adaptability as DevOps supports continuous adaptation based on instantaneous feedback, moving away from rigid, predefined methods towards a more adaptable, "industrial-scale agile" engineering discipline (Gruhn & Striemer, 2018). Sixth is DevOps is compatible with modern architectural styles as DevOps fosters the use of modern architectural patterns like microservices architectures and containerization (Kratzke, 2018).

Commented [NJ4]: Good impacts

Commented [NJ5]: Roles?

3. Framework

Back when Xero was founded in 2006 (*About Xero | Xero NZ*, 2024), one of the current frameworks around that time is TOGAF (The Open Group Architecture Framework). For a software company like Xero, TOGAF can help Xero with their goal of making life better for small businesses around the world (*Our Values: We Make It Xero*, 2025).

First is that the TOGAF's central component, Architecture Development Method (ADM), which is a step-by-step approach for building, managing, and implementing enterprise architecture and information systems. This methodology can help an organization in defining business needs, comprehensive planning, and systematic problem solving (Amalia

& Supriadi, 2017). Second is that TOGAF combines information and technology systems architectures to align with both corporate and IT team goals (de Oliveira et al., 2021). For Xero that focuses on serving small businesses, it can help with IT capabilities and software development efforts be in sync with your strategic business objectives (Amanda et al., 2023), and design solutions that are truly aligned with your clients' operational needs and strategic goals, rather than just technical requirements (Qurratuaini, 2018). Third is that it is helpful for small and medium enterprises, TOGAF is described as a scalable framework that can be tailored to fit numerous situations and organizational cultures. This is important for a company that serves a diverse range of small businesses (Alm & Wißotzki, 2013). TOGAF is useful for companies undergoing significant change. If Xero's small business clients are in dynamic environments or experiencing growth, TOGAF can help them adapt their IT infrastructure effectively (Alm & Wißotzki, 2013). Fourth is that TOGAF has been used in various businesses that are relevant to software development for small businesses, TOGAF can be used for enterprise architecture planning in contexts like computer laboratory software engineering (Amalia & Supriadi, 2017), and for designing specific reporting information systems (mobile and web-based) (Hermawan & Sumitra, 2019). For small businesses, Xero can use TOGAF to help in optimizing existing IT platforms, integrating scattered applications, and improving the implementation and creation of Standard Operating Procedures by converting manual processes into automation. This will improve the efficiency of small businesses that Xero serves (Girsang & Abimanyu, 2021). However, TOGAF can be too complex and abstract, potentially generating excessive costs and overhead, particularly for small businesses (Alm & Wißotzki, 2013). Implementation of TOGAF often requires assistance from external experts with significant experience, which can be quite expensive (Alm & Wißotzki, 2013).

Commented [NJ6]: Discussing the suitability

To improve Xero's goal of helping goal of making life better for small businesses around the world (*Our Values: We Make It Xero*, 2025). Adopting the Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) is beneficial for Xero for many reasons. First is that SAFe emphasizes a strong focus on customer value and recommends involving customers at every level (Kasauli et al., 2021). It helps teams deliver features that are truly useful to the customer (Gregory et al., 2021). By involving the customers at every level, Xero can deliver service that will benefit their customers. Second is that SAFe is designed to accelerate time-to-market, enabling companies to deliver products in weeks rather than years (Petit & Marnewick, 2021). SAFe support the continuous flow of incremental releases of value (Beecham et al., 2021). This means small businesses can receive new features, updates, and solutions more rapidly, allowing them to adapt quickly to their own market changes and gain competitive advantages (Gregory et al., 2021). For Xero's clients, quick and early releases can help them gain an edge against their competitors. Third is that Agile methods are inherently designed to handle changes in system requirements effectively (Gregory et al., 2021). This flexibility is crucial for software products that serve dynamic small business environments, ensuring that the solutions remain current and effective(Petit & Marnewick, 2021). For Xero, using SAFe can allow them to handle changing requirements, which ensures that the services and solutions are still relevant to their customers.

However, one weakness of SAFe is that Agile methods were originally designed for small, co-located teams (Shameem et al., 2020). Scaling them to large organizations introduces significant complexity (Beecham et al., 2021). Another weakness is that SAFe adopt a "one-size-fits-all" approach that may not suit the unique needs and particularities of every project, organization, or team (Camara et al., 2024). For Xero, it is important to notice these strengths and weaknesses and weight their options.

4. Conclusion

Xero, which was founded in 2006, could benefit from old frameworks like TOGAF as TOGAF offers structured enterprise architecture that is aligned with business goals, but may be too complex and costly for small business clients. SAFe emphasizes customer value, adaptability, and faster delivery, though SAFe may be too complex for large companies and it is not a one size fits all approach.

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